FLEET TEAM DIGEST

737MAX-FTD-33-20002

Issue Title : Tailcone Anti-Collision and Aft Position Light Inoperative

Airplane Model	ATA	Minor Model(s)
737MAX	3344-04	-7, -8, -8200, -9, -BBJ
Other Model(s)	**ECCN**	
	9E991	

Originated Date	Last Revised Date	Created On
12/23/2020	02/02/2022	01/23/2022
Estimated Completion Date	**Next Update Date**	

Revision Description

Updated final action.

Applicability

All 737MAX airplanes.

Description

During 737MAX de-preservation activities, Boeing started receiving reports of inoperative Tailcone Anti-Collision and Aft Position Light P/N 84091-1. This light assembly provides both anti-collision and position light functions using a common array of 12 White LEDs. There are two installed on the airplane, one on the left and one on the right side of the tailcone.

Status

Initial review of the field returns identified that the leading root cause of inoperative lights are yellowed End of Life (EOL) chambers. The yellow chamber reduces the light received from the operating LED and simulates severe LED intensity degradation. This condition causes the light to believe that it is near the end of its useful life when it is not, and shuts down the light prematurely.

Root cause evaluation performed by the supplier (Astronics LSI) concluded that the degradation of the LED EOL chamber material is due to trace metal contamination in combination with the adverse effect of the LED spectral properties. Engineering analysis showed that storage/non-operating conditions are contributing to the degradation. Testing have shown that the yellowing will clear over time when the lights are operational to a bleaching effect of the LEDs UV characteristics. Current data shows that this failure mode is not expected to occur on airplanes in continuous operation.

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Interim Action

Operators can refer to the following FIM Tasks for inoperative tailcone light fault isolation:

- Anti-collision light does not operate correctly, tailcone left: 33-44-00-810-806
- Anti-collision light does not operate correctly, tailcone right: 33-44-00-810-807
- Position light does not operate correctly, tailcone left: 33-43-00-810-805
- Position light does not operate correctly, tailcone right: 33-43-00-810-806

Operators experiencing inop tailcone lights should replace the LED module, P/N 87-04921-001, per AMM TASK 33-43-13-960-803 or TASK 33-44-04-960-803, before replacing the whole light LRU. Replacing the LED module is expected to restore the inoperative lights to a working condition. Send removed LED Modules or LRUs to the supplier (Astronics LSI) for a failure analysis.

For airplanes in prolonged parking, we recommend a periodic operational check of the position and anti-collision light function of the tailcone lights as a proactive check for inoperative lights prior to return to service.

Final Action

No design change is planned for this light assembly. Investigation results concluded that this failure mode is not expected to occur once the fleet is in continuous operation.

Milestones

Root Cause Established: April 2021

Solution Selected: January 2022

Reference Categories

Reference Type	Reference Number	Revision Number	Reference Date
Aircraft Maintenance Manual (AMM)	33-43-13-960-803		
Fault Isolation Manual (FIM)	33-44-00-810-806		
Fault Isolation Manual (FIM)	33-44-00-810-807		
Fault Isolation Manual (FIM)	33-43-00-810-805		
Fault Isolation Manual (FIM)	33-43-00-810-806		
Minimum Equipment List (MEL)	33-43-01		
Minimum Equipment List (MEL)	33-44-02		
Aircraft Maintenance Manual (AMM)	33-44-04-960-803		

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Parts List

Part Name	Boeing Part Number	Supplier Name	Supplier Number
Tailcone Anti-Collision and Aft Position Light	S283A329-1	Astronics LSI	84091-1
LED Module		Astronics LSI	87-04921-001

Related Categories

- Component Issues : Issues that occur during component maintenance or have an impact on component reliability

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